

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



INDIA-SRI LANKA - 2

MODULE - 28

The contemporary relationship can be discussed under the following heads

1. Political
2. Strategic
3. Defence
4. Economic
5. Regional
6. Cultural and Educational
7. Capacity Building
8. People-to-people ties



POLITICAL

- India's foreign policy decisions are guided by a combination of **geostrategic, political and socio-cultural factors**.
- Through “Synergy and Understanding” and Modi's ‘Neighbourhood Policy’, India has accorded top priority to Sri Lanka.

1 Relations between two countries are affected by internal factors like the **Sinhala versus Tamil conflict**.

2 In 2012, India and Sri Lanka inaugurated ‘**The India Show-Land of Limitless Opportunities**’ at Colombo.

3 PM Modi visited the war-ravaged Jaffna and re-affirmed India's **commitment to the 13th Amendment** for devolution of powers.

4 Between 2015 and 2017, high level visits between leaders of India and Sri Lanka took place which led to the **signing of four bilateral pacts- Agreement on visa, customs, youth development and building the Tagore memorial**.

13th Amendment

Section 1. Neither slavery nor involuntary servitude, except as a punishment for crime whereof the party shall have been duly convicted, shall exist within the United States, or any place subject to their jurisdiction.

Section 2. Congress shall have power to enforce this article by appropriate legislation.

POLITICAL

Political relations are marked by high level visits.

SIRISENA'S VISITS TO INDIA

- 1** May 2016 – President visited Ujjain to attend the valedictory session of the Simhastha Kumbh Mela. He also visited Sanchi and unveiled a statue of Anagarika Dharmapala
- 2** October 2016 – President visited Goa to attend the BRICS-BIMSTEC Outreach Summit
- 3** November 2016 – President attended the WHO Framework Convention on Tobacco Control
- 4** March 2018 – President attended the founding Conference of International Solar Alliance
- 5** May 2019- President attended the swearing in ceremony of PM Narendra Modi.



POLITICAL

WICKREMESINGHE'S VISITS TO INDIA

- 1 October 2016 – PM attended the India Economic Summit
- 2 April 2017 – PM signed an MoU on Cooperation in Economic Projects
- 3 November 2017 – PM attended the Global Conference on Cyber Space
- 4 October 2018 – PM was on official visit.



STRATEGIC

- 1 The Indian state of Tamil Nadu and northern Sri Lanka are separated by the Palk Strait
- 2 In India's efforts towards ensuring maritime security, peace and prosperity in the Indian Ocean, Sri Lanka's geographical location is of critical importance to India.
- 3 Moreover, with regards to Southeast Asia, Sri Lanka can serve as a gateway to the East.
- 4 India is keen on engaging with Sri Lanka as a part of its Neighbour First Policy and SAGAR Doctrine.
- 5 Sri Lanka has a list of highly strategic ports located among busiest sea lanes of communication.



STRATEGIC

- 6 Sri Lanka's Colombo Port is the 25th busiest container port in the world and the natural deep water harbour at Trincomalee is the fifth largest natural harbour in the world.
- 7 India, Sri Lanka and Maldives signed a trilateral maritime security cooperation agreement to improve surveillance, anti-piracy operations and reducing maritime pollution in Indian Ocean Region.
- 8 Sri Lanka contributes to Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA) with its geo-strategic location and experience in maritime safety and security issues.



STRATEGIC

CHINA FACTOR

Over the years, China's presence has increased in the country.

- China is encircling India to establish control over the Indian Ocean through its String of Pearls Policy
- As part of China's Maritime Silk Route (MSR) policy, China has built two ports in Sri Lanka- Colombo and Hambantota.
- China has collaborated with Sri Lanka's satellite operator Supreme SAT (Pvt.) for satellite launching activities.



DEFENCE RELATIONS

- 1 The countries enjoy a growing defence relationship built on extensive training and Service-to-Service linkages.
- 2 India sold weapons and provided critical naval and intelligence support to Sri Lanka during the 1971 rebellion
- 3 India has trained the Sri Lankan military across the three branches of the armed forces.
- 4 The countries signed a civilian nuclear cooperation agreement through which they share knowledge, expertise and resources, cooperate in capacity building and training of personnel in peaceful uses of nuclear energy.



DEFENCE RELATIONS

5 On the maritime front, a hotline has been installed between the coast guards for better coordination among the maritime security forces.

6 There is growing cooperation between navies of the two countries through SLINEX.

7 India and Sri Lanka conducts joint Military ('Mitra Shakti') which focuses on counter-insurgency and counter-terrorism operations

8 Dosti is a trilateral coast guard exercise among India, Sri Lanka and Maldives.

9 In April 2019, India and Sri Lanka also concluded agreement on countering Drug and Human trafficking.



ECONOMIC

i TALAIMANNAR AND JAFFNA

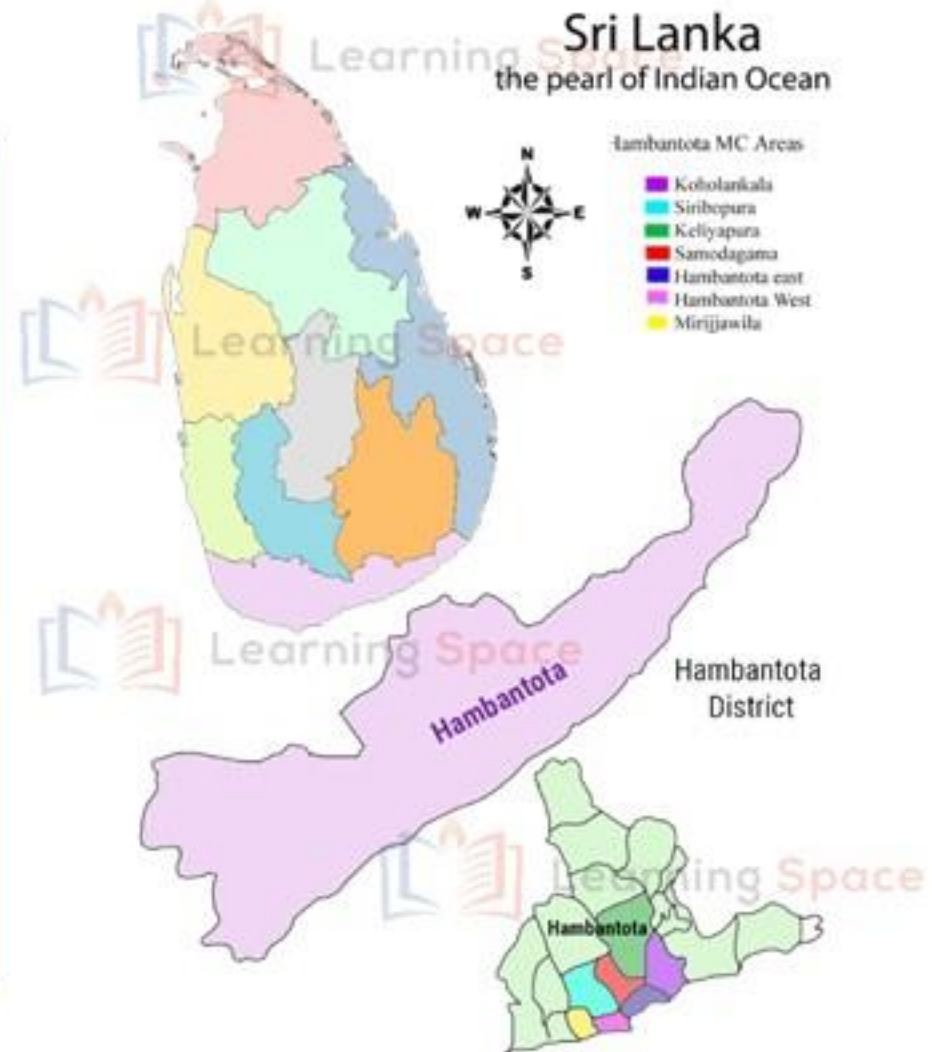
- 1 PM Modi visited Talaimannar and Jaffna in 2015 and it was extremely significant and relevant in the context of India's engagement in infrastructure development in Sri Lanka.
- 2 He is the first Indian Prime Minister to visit the place; especially vital in the context of Tamil politics.
- 3 In Talaimannar, PM Modi flagged off the first train service between Talaimannar and Colombo.



ECONOMIC

ii HAMBANTOTA

- 1 Sri Lanka signed an agreement with India to build 1,200 houses in Hambantota. Hambantota is right in the middle of vital energy supply lines in the Indian Ocean, connecting the Middle East and East Asia.
- 2 The signing of the MoU in Hambantota assumes significance not only in its timing, but also in taking India's housing project to the Sinhala majority Southern Province.



ECONOMIC

iii INFRASTRUCTURE

1 The infrastructure projects are a part of USD 800 million credit provided by India.

2 As a part of India's ongoing housing project in Sri Lanka to help construct 63,000 houses, India has built 155 houses so far.

3 India is also involved in projects for renovation of Palaly Airport, Kankesanthurai Harbour, construction of cultural centre in Jaffna and interconnection of electricity grids between two countries.

4 India continues to assist many small development projects in areas like education, health, transport connectivity, small and medium enterprises development in many parts of the country.



ECONOMIC

iv TRADE

- 1 The India-Sri Lanka Free Trade Agreement was signed in March 2000 and trade expanded between them.
- 2 The basic premise in signing the ISFTA was asymmetries between the two economies, local socio-economic sensitivities, safeguard measures to protect domestic interests, and revenue implications so as not to impact high revenue generating tariff lines in the short term.
- 3 Bilateral trade during January to November 2019 amounted to USD 4.19 billion.
- 4 The main items of exports from Sri Lanka to India are Base Oil, Poultry feeds, Areca nuts, (waste and scrap) paper or paperboard, Pepper, Ignition Wiring Sets, Copper wire, Marble, travertine and alabaster.



ECONOMIC

iv TRADE

5 Main items of Imports from India to Sri Lanka are Gas oil/ Diesel, Motorcycles, Pharmaceutical Products, Portland cement, Semi finished products of Iron, Military weapon, Fuel oil, Rice, Cement clinkers, Kerosene Type jet Fuel.

6 India is one of the largest investors in Sri Lanka with investments in areas of petroleum retail, IT, financial services, real estate, telecommunication, hospitality & tourism, banking and food processing (tea & fruit juices), copper and other metal industries), tires, cement, glass manufacturing, and infrastructure development (railway, power, water supply).

7 Indian Chambers and Sri Lankan Chambers have signed MOUs to promote trade and economic relations, investments between India and Sri-Lanka.



ECONOMIC



TRADE AGREEMENTS

1 The agreement CEPA (Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement) which is yet to be signed between the countries, seeks to build on the momentum generated by the FTA and take the two economies beyond trade in goods towards greater integration and impart renewed impetus and synergy to bilateral economic interaction.

2 Indian Minister of Law and Justice and Electronics & Information Technology visited Sri Lanka from 14-17 January, 2018 and signed an MoU for Cooperation in IT & Electronics was signed.



ECONOMIC

V

TRADE AGREEMENTS

- 3 The proposed ETCA is expected to further trade in services, investments and technological cooperation; enhance capacity building in the IT sector and ship-building
- 4 With ETCA signed, Indian investments will flow into Sri Lanka to make the island's production facilities part of the Indian and international value chain.
- 5 India and Sri Lanka have signed an agreement on revised Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement (DTAA).



REGIONAL

SAARC

- 1 India and Sri Lanka have cooperated very closely on the economic front with Sri Lanka being India's second largest trading partner in SAARC.
- 2 Sri Lanka came out in support for India in 2016 by pulling out of the SAARC Summit to be held in Pakistan.
- 3 The countries were boycotting the summit on account of the attack on the Indian army base camp in Jammu and Kashmir by Pakistan-based terrorist.



REGIONAL

BIMSTEC

- 1 Singapore, Indonesia and Malaysia and Sri Lanka suggested the creation of a large Special Economic Zone (SEZ) around the Bay of Bengal, as a part of BIMSTEC Cooperation
- 2 India invited leaders of BIMSTEC member countries to attend the swearing-in of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and his council of ministers

India voted against Sri Lanka in 2009, 2012 and 2013 at the US-sponsored UNHRC resolution to investigate alleged human rights violations in Sri Lanka.



CULTURAL AND EDUCATIONAL

- 1** The Cultural Cooperation Agreement signed by the Government of India and the Government of Sri Lanka in November, 1977 at New Delhi forms the basis for periodic Cultural Exchange Program between the two countries
- 2** The India-Sri Lanka Foundation, was an intergovernmental initiative set up in December 1998, for the enhancement of scientific, technical, educational and cultural cooperation through civil society exchanges and enhancing contact between the younger generations of the two countries.



INDIA - SRI LANKA



F O U N D A T I O N

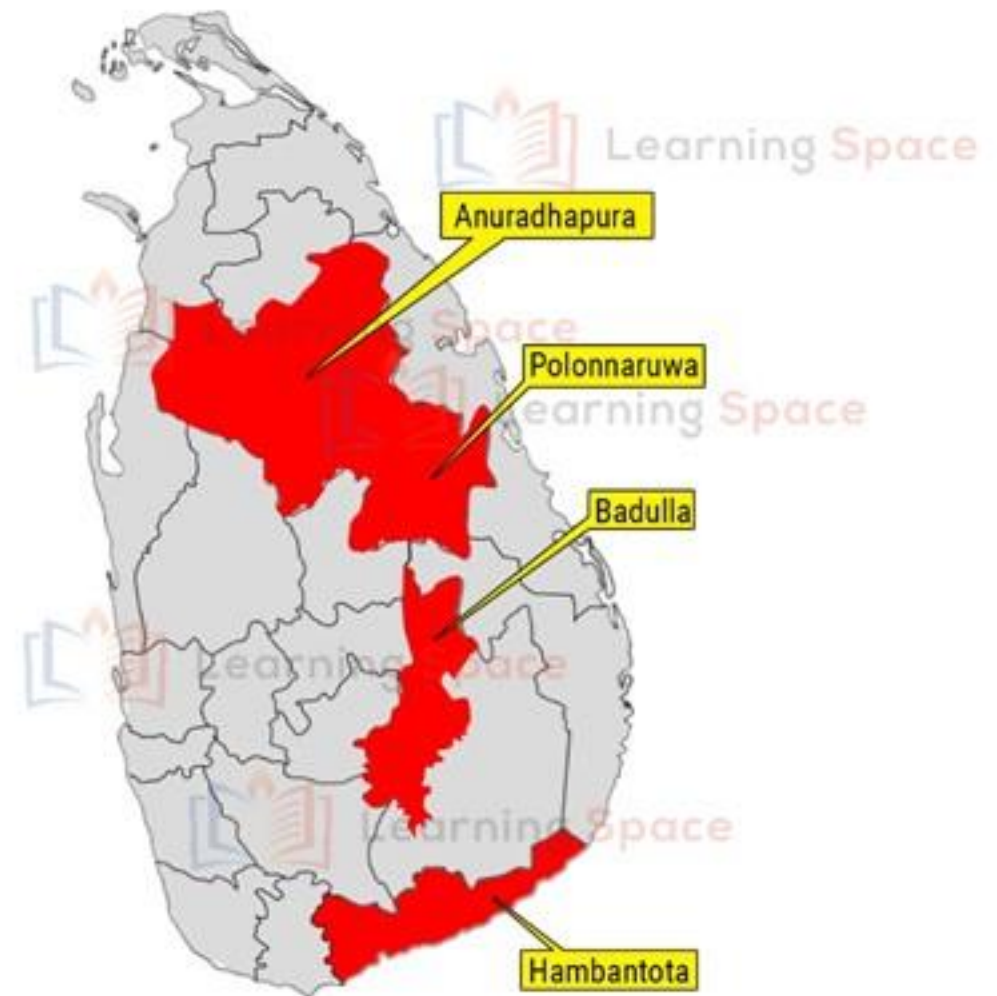
CULTURAL AND EDUCATIONAL

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BUDDHISM

Buddhism is one of the biggest cultural connect between India and Sri Lanka.

- 1 In 2015, PM Modi visited the politically and culturally important the Mahabodhi Society in Colombo, Buddhist religious place of Anuradhapura, Talaimannar, Jaffna and Sri Lankan Parliament. The choice of these places is important in the context of the International Buddhist Circuit.
- 2 The Mahabodhi Society is a South Asian Buddhist society founded by the Sri Lankan leader.



CULTURAL AND EDUCATIONAL

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BUDDHISM

- 3 Anuradhapura is the ancient capital of Sri Lanka and the place where Ashoka's son came to preach Buddhism. It was established around a cutting from the 'Tree of Enlightenment'.
- 4 Sri Lanka is an important member in establishing the International Buddhist University in Sanchi.
- 5 India and Sri Lanka have agreed to undertake joint activities to commemorate the 2600th year of Buddha attaining enlightenment.
- 6 Sacred relics from Sarnath were brought to Sri Lanka for the Vesak exposition organized from 29 April to 2 May 2018.



CULTURAL AND EDUCATIONAL

ii MAHATMA GANDHI

- 1 As a part of Commencement of 150th Birth Anniversary Celebrations of Mahatma Gandhi in Sri Lanka, postal stamps on Gandhi ji was released by the Prime Minister of Sri Lanka.
- 2 Former Prime Minister Ranil Wickremesinghe and High Commissioner unveiled a bronze bust of Gandhiji at Temple Trees, official residence of Sri Lankan Prime Minister.

iii YOGA

- 1 The Indian Cultural Centre in Colombo promotes awareness of Indian culture by offering classes in Indian music, dance, Hindi and Yoga.
- 2 Yoga is performed by several enthusiasts on International Day of Yoga on 21 June 2015 in Sri Lanka



CAPACITY BUILDING

- 1** Sri Lankan students can also appear for National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET) in centres in India for MBBS/BDS admissions. IIT JEE (Advanced) entrance examinations have commenced in Sri Lanka from 2017.
- 2** Prime Minister Modi has announced the extension of the Indian-aided ambulance service to more areas in Sri Lanka.
- 3** India now offers about 710 scholarship slots annually to Sri Lankan students, including study in Sri Lanka and in India.
- 4** According to unofficial statistics, it is estimated that around 14,000 Indian expatriates are living in Sri Lanka. Tamil Diaspora are mostly employed in either tea or rubber plantations.



INDIAN COMMUNITY

1 The People of Indian Origin (PIOs) comprise Sindhis, Borahs, Gujaratis, Memons, Parsis, Malayalis and Telugu speaking persons who have settled down in Sri Lanka and are engaged in various business ventures.

2 They are economically prosperous and are mostly employed in either tea or rubber plantations in Central, Uva and Sabaragamuwa Provinces organizes festivals and cultural events.

3 According to unofficial statistics, it is estimated that around 14,000 Indian expatriates are living in Sri Lanka.

4 To further strengthen people-to-people ties, the first ever pilgrimage to Bodh Gaya for Sri Lankan Armed Forces personnel and their families was organized from 24-26 June 2018.



**PM Modi interacts
with Indian community
in Sri Lanka**

INDIAN COMMUNITY

- 5 The second pilgrimage visit to Bodh Gaya was organized by India on June 2019 for Sri Lankan Armed forces and their families and for the first time Indian contingent arrived in Sri Lanka to visit Sri Lankan sites.
- 6 During Prime Minister's visit to Colombo in May 2017, Air India flights between Varanasi and Colombo was announced from 4 August 2017 On 11 November 2019 Alliance Air started regular service between Jaffna and Chennai.
- 7 Government of India formally launched the e-Tourist Visa (eTV) scheme for Sri Lankan tourists on 14 April 2015. On 24 July 2019 Sri Lanka included India in the free visa on arrival scheme and commenced the scheme on 1 August 2019

Tourism also forms an important link between India and Sri Lanka and India is the largest source market for Sri Lankan tourism. In tourism, India is the largest contributor with every fifth tourist being from India.



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